

Violence, Safety, Mobility, And Labor-Market Access

Gender Study — Week 7

Teaching deck draft

Central question

- How do safety, harassment, violence, mobility constraints, and reproductive autonomy shape labor-market access?
- Which margins move: participation, search, acceptance, occupations, quits, retention, wages, or welfare?
- What data make hidden harms visible?
- When are wages and employment incomplete welfare measures?

Why Week 7 is distinct from Week 6

Week 6	Week 7
Policy incidence	Constraints and hidden harms
Which policy margin moves?	Which jobs are actually feasible?
Who bears incidence?	Who faces risk, control, or restricted mobility?
Firm and household adjustment	Search, safety, reporting, and option value

Safety as a labor constraint

- Safety changes the feasible set of jobs, not only the utility of a job already chosen.
- Violence and harassment can reduce applications, acceptance, hours, mobility, and retention.
- Reproductive autonomy changes career timing and future option value.
- Hidden harms can remain invisible in wages and employment status.

$$\mathcal{F}_{it} = \{j \in \mathcal{J}_t : m_{ijt} \leq \bar{m}_{it}, r_{ijt} \leq \bar{r}_{it}, q_{ijt} \geq \bar{q}_{it}, a_{it} \geq \bar{a}_{it}\}$$

- m : commute or mobility burden.
- r : safety, violence, or harassment risk.
- q : job quality and reporting environment.
- a : reproductive control and timing feasibility.

Job utility is not just the wage

$$U_{ijt} = w_{jt} - \phi h_{jt} - \kappa m_{ijt} - \rho r_{ijt} - \psi H_{ijt} + A_{ijt} + \Omega_{it}(T_{it}) + \varepsilon_{ijt}$$

- H : hidden harm, fear, stigma, retaliation, reporting cost.
- A : amenities, dignity, authority, job quality.
- Ω : option value from timing and control.

Five margins to keep separate

- ① Safety as a price or disutility margin.
- ② Safety as a mobility and search margin.
- ③ Safety as a retention and exit margin.
- ④ Safety as a hidden welfare margin.
- ⑤ Reproductive autonomy as a timing and control margin.

Domestic violence and intimate-partner violence

- Labor mechanism: control over mobility, job search, income, and outside options.
- Observed margins: participation, absenteeism, hours instability, job loss, search intensity.
- Identification challenge: violence, work, bargaining power, and household selection are jointly determined.
- Useful data: police or court reports, health records, surveys, local labor shocks, employment panels.

Domestic violence evidence

- Heath: labor opportunities, control over resources, and domestic violence in Bangladesh.
- Aizer: relative labor-market opportunities as bargaining-power variation.
- Frankenthal: productivity shocks and domestic violence as a newer frontier setting.
- Design lesson: name the direction of causality and the margin observed.

- Adams-Prassl, Huttunen, Nix, and Zhang link reported workplace violence to labor-market records.
- Observed margins: victim outcomes, coworker spillovers, separations, firm hiring, workplace composition.
- Identification challenge: reported incidents are selected and may reveal broader unsafe environments.
- Design lesson: administrative linkage can show responses ordinary wage data miss.

- Folke and Rickne treat sexual harassment as a source of labor-market inequality.
- Harassment can generate quits, occupational segregation, and wage-risk tradeoffs.
- A higher wage in a hostile job is not automatically a welfare improvement.
- Reporting costs make complaints an equilibrium outcome, not a clean exposure measure.

Power inside the workplace

- Office relationships with supervisors raise internal-labor-market questions.
- Margins: promotion, retention, coworker exits, perceived fairness, retaliation risk.
- Key challenge: separate consent, power asymmetry, favoritism, harassment risk, and spillovers.
- Data need hierarchy, timing, worker outcomes, and coworker outcomes.

Mobility, commuting, and public-space safety

- A posted job is not accessible if the route, time, or transport mode is unsafe.
- Mobility risk can shrink search radius and application sets before accepted jobs appear.
- Safer transport can affect applications, attendance, hours, job acceptance, and time use.
- Non-applications are usually invisible in standard labor-force data.

- Randomized transport or mobility interventions directly move commute constraints.
- Application data reveal search radius and jobs never accepted.
- Time-use data reveal whether safer mobility reallocates time toward work, education, or care.
- Safety perceptions and local incident data help interpret the mechanism.

Reproductive autonomy as labor timing

- Birth control affects expected fertility timing before pregnancy occurs.
- Abortion access or denial affects whether pregnancy becomes a binding work and care constraint.
- IVF and fertility treatment can relax biological timing constraints and provide identification.
- The labor object is timing, control, and option value.

- Goldin and Katz: contraception access and women's career and marriage decisions.
- Design family: historical and policy access variation.
- Observed margins: schooling, professional investment, marriage timing, career commitment.
- Mechanism: lower uncertainty raises returns to long human-capital investments.

- Miller, Wherry, and Foster: economic consequences of being denied an abortion.
- Design family: quasi-experimental comparison around provider gestational limits.
- Observed margins: labor-market paths, financial distress, family structure.
- Mechanism: control over whether and when pregnancy affects work and care.

IVF and fertility treatment

- Lundborg, Plug, and Rasmussen use IVF treatment success as an instrument.
- Observed margins: childbearing, hours, earnings, career paths.
- Strength: isolates fertility timing among women seeking treatment.
- Limitation: local to the IVF population and treatment context.

Hidden harms and reporting

- Exposure is latent: many incidents are never reported.
- Reporting depends on retaliation risk, stigma, documentation, job security, and trust.
- Labor response is selected: workers with good outside options may leave first.
- Welfare may improve when measured wages fall if the move is toward safety.

$$V_{it} = E_t \sum_{\tau=t}^T \beta^{\tau-t} [c_{i\tau} - \phi h_{i\tau} - \rho r_{i\tau} - \psi H_{i\tau} + A_{i\tau} + \Omega_{i\tau}]$$

- Wages and employment are observed components, not the full welfare object.
- Safety, dignity, reporting costs, and option value must enter interpretation.

Research designs and what they identify

Design	What it can identify	Main threat
Admin legal linkage	reported incident and labor response	selected reporting
Survey plus admin	latent exposure and labor outcomes	survey selection
Randomized transport	mobility/search constraint	spillovers and compliance
Legal/judicial quasi-experiment	access or denial shock	local population
IVF-based IV	fertility timing effect	local to IVF patients
Boundary discontinuity	access gradient near a rule	manipulation or sorting

- Reproduce: synthetic administrative-linkage exercise inspired by workplace violence evidence.
- Diagnose: classify exposure, reporting, retention, firm response, coworker spillover, and hidden welfare.
- Transfer: harassment-risk sorting exercise inspired by Folke and Rickne.
- Optional memo: office relationships, hierarchy, and workplace spillovers.

- Safety, mobility, legal credibility, and reproductive access vary across countries and regions.
- The same mechanism may appear as nonparticipation, informal work, migration, segregation, or hidden welfare loss.
- Week 8 asks which gender-and-labor mechanisms travel and which depend on development, institutions, and norms.

Takeaways

- Safety and reproductive autonomy are labor-market constraints and welfare objects.
- Hidden harms enter through search, mobility, sorting, quits, retention, and option value.
- Good evidence names the constraint, the observed margin, and the design.
- Wages and employment are necessary but incomplete for welfare interpretation.